



100

Business Intelligence Analyst Interview Questions

Technical, Behavioral, and Business/Scenario-Based
Questions With Example Answers





Welcome

Congratulations on taking an important step toward launching or advancing your career as a Business Intelligence Analyst.

This guide contains 100 carefully selected interview questions across technical, behavioral, and business/scenario-based categories — along with example answers to help you prepare thoughtfully and confidently.

Whether you're preparing for your very first BI role or sharpening your skills for a new opportunity, this guide is designed to help you:

- Understand what employers are looking for
- Practice structuring strong, professional answers
- Build confidence for interviews at every stage

Take your time, study the questions, and use the examples as inspiration to craft answers that reflect your own experiences and strengths.

Wishing you success on your journey,

Adam Finer
Founder, Learn BI Academy



Technical Questions

Essential skills and knowledge every entry-level Business
Intelligence Analyst should master.

Technical

Question 1

What is the difference between a primary key and a foreign key in a database?

A primary key uniquely identifies each record in a table, while a foreign key links records between two tables.

Technical

Question 2

How would you explain an inner join to someone who has never used SQL?

An inner join combines records from two tables where there is a matching value in both tables.

Technical

Question 3

What is normalization and why is it important in database design?

Normalization organizes data to reduce redundancy and improve integrity by dividing it into related tables.

Technical

Question 4

What are some common types of SQL joins and when would you use each one?

Common joins are INNER JOIN (matching rows), LEFT JOIN (all rows from the left table), RIGHT JOIN, and FULL JOIN.

Technical

Question 5

How would you find duplicate records in a table using SQL?

Use GROUP BY and HAVING COUNT() > 1 to find duplicates based on the desired columns.*

Technical

Question 6

What is a data warehouse, and how is it different from a transactional database?

A data warehouse stores historical data optimized for analysis, while transactional databases focus on day-to-day operations.

Technical

Question 7

What does ETL stand for, and what are the basic steps involved?

ETL stands for Extract, Transform, Load – moving data from source systems into a storage system after cleaning it.

Technical

Question 8

What is the difference between OLTP and OLAP systems?

OLTP systems handle real-time transactions; OLAP systems are designed for analytical querying of large data sets.

Technical

Question 9

How would you optimize a slow SQL query?

*Optimize queries by using indexes, avoiding SELECT *, and filtering early in the query.*

Technical

Question 10

What is a dimension table and what is a fact table?

A dimension table contains descriptive attributes; a fact table holds quantitative data for analysis.

Technical

Question 11

How would you calculate year-over-year growth in SQL?

Subtract last year's sales from this year's sales, then divide by last year's sales to get the growth rate.

Technical

Question 12

What are indexes in databases and how do they improve performance?

Indexes speed up database reads by allowing quick lookup of records based on key columns.

Technical

Question 13

What is a CTE (Common Table Expression) and when would you use one?

A CTE is a temporary result set you can reference within a SQL query to make complex queries easier to read.

Technical

Question 14

How would you handle NULL values in a dataset you are analyzing?

You can replace NULLs with appropriate values, filter them out, or flag them depending on the analysis.

Technical

Question 15

What is the purpose of using CASE statements in SQL?

CASE statements let you add conditional logic to SQL queries, like IF-THEN-ELSE for custom fields.

Technical

Question 16

How would you approach cleaning a messy dataset in Excel?

Remove duplicates, fix inconsistent formatting, fill in missing values, and validate against expected patterns.

Technical

Question 17

What are some common data types you encounter when working with databases?

Common data types include integers, floats, text (strings), dates, and booleans (true/false).

Technical

Question 18

How would you create a calculated field in Power BI or Tableau?

In Power BI or Tableau, a calculated field is a custom field you create by applying a formula to existing fields.

Technical

Question 19

What is a KPI and how would you select which KPIs to track in a dashboard?

A KPI is a key performance indicator. Choose KPIs based on what best measures progress toward business goals.

Technical

Question 20

What is the difference between `COUNT(*)`, `COUNT(column)`, and `COUNT(DISTINCT column)` in SQL?

*`COUNT(*)` counts all rows;
`COUNT(column)` counts non-null values;
`COUNT(DISTINCT column)` counts
unique non-null values.*

Technical

Question 21

How do you ensure that the data in your dashboard updates regularly?

Use scheduled refresh options in your BI tool to update dashboards at regular intervals automatically.

Technical

Question 22

What are measures and dimensions in BI tools like Tableau or Power BI?

Measures are numerical aggregations (like sum of sales); dimensions are categories like region or product.

Technical

Question 23

How would you connect multiple tables together in Power BI?

Connect tables by defining relationships, usually through keys like CustomerID or ProductID.

Technical

Question 24

How would you handle a many-to-many relationship in a BI tool?

Use bridge tables or summarize data to manage many-to-many relationships in BI models.

Technical

Question 25

What is a star schema, and why is it commonly used in reporting?

A star schema organizes data into a central fact table connected to dimension tables, simplifying analysis.

Technical

Question 26

What are the benefits of using a cloud data warehouse like Google BigQuery or Snowflake?

Cloud data warehouses offer scalability, speed, and lower maintenance compared to traditional on-premise solutions.

Technical

Question 27

How would you explain a LEFT JOIN with an example?

A LEFT JOIN returns all records from the left table and matches from the right table where possible, otherwise NULLs.

Technical

Question 28

How would you troubleshoot a Power BI report that is running slowly?

Check filters, data model complexity, and large visuals that could slow down your Power BI report.

Technical

Question 29

How would you approach building a simple sales dashboard?

Start by identifying key metrics, choosing simple visuals, and keeping the layout clean and focused.

Technical

Question 30

What is data aggregation and why is it important in reporting?

Aggregation summarizes data (e.g., sum, average) to make large datasets easier to analyze meaningfully.

Technical

Question 31

How do you decide when to use a bar chart versus a line chart?

Use a bar chart to compare quantities between categories, and a line chart to show trends over time.

Technical

Question 32

What is the difference between a report and a dashboard?

A report is usually static and detailed; a dashboard is interactive and focuses on key high-level metrics.

Technical

Question 33

What is a filter versus a slicer in Power BI?

Filters refine the data shown; slicers offer a visual, user-friendly way for users to filter themselves.

Technical

Question 34

How would you identify and handle outliers in your data?

Identify values significantly higher or lower than normal; investigate and treat based on business logic.

Technical

Question 35

What are parameters in Tableau, and how are they used?

Parameters are user-defined values that allow users to control inputs dynamically in Tableau dashboards.

Technical

Question 36

What steps would you take to validate the accuracy of a report before delivering it?

Double-check source data, validate key metrics manually, and perform logic checks to ensure report accuracy.

Technical

Question 37

How do you manage version control when multiple people are working on the same BI project?

Use version control tools, clear naming conventions, and document changes when collaborating on BI projects.

Technical

Question 38

What is DAX and where is it used?

DAX is a formula language used in Power BI to create custom calculations and aggregations.

Technical

Question 39

How would you export SQL query results into Excel?

Use SQL client export options or query outputs directly to a CSV, then open it in Excel.

Technical

Question 40

What are best practices for naming fields and tables in a database?

Use clear and descriptive names for both fields and tables to make the database easy to understand. Avoid spaces and special characters – use underscores (_) to separate words if needed.

Technical

Question 41

How do you approach building a report when the stakeholders aren't clear about what they want?

Start by asking clarifying questions to identify the real business problem or goals before building the report.

Technical

Question 42

How would you write a SQL query to show the top 10 customers by sales?

Write a SQL query that groups sales by customer, sums them, orders them in descending order, and limits to 10.

Technical

Question 43

What does data granularity mean, and why does it matter?

Granularity is the level of detail in the data – finer granularity means more detailed records.

Technical

Question 44

What is data lineage and why is it important?

Data lineage tracks where data comes from and how it has changed, helping ensure trust in reports.

Technical

Question 45

How would you describe the process of joining a customer table and an orders table?

Join the customer table to the orders table using the customer ID to combine customer and order details.

Technical

Question 46

What is data profiling, and how would you perform it?

Data profiling examines a dataset to understand its structure, quality, and patterns before deeper analysis.

Technical

Question 47

How would you prevent duplicate records when importing data into a dashboard?

*Use de-duplication techniques like **DISTINCT** or groupings to avoid duplicate entries when importing.*

Technical

Question 48

What is the role of primary keys when designing a data model?

Primary keys ensure each record is unique, supporting accurate joins and data integrity.

Technical

Question 49

How would you automate refreshing a dashboard connected to a SQL database?

Use scheduled refreshes when data is imported into the BI tool, to keep snapshots up to date. If the dashboard uses a live connection to the SQL database, scheduled refreshes aren't needed because data is pulled in real-time.

Technical

Question 50

How would you explain the difference between transactional data and aggregated data to a non-technical stakeholder?

Transactional data records individual events; aggregated data summarizes those events over a period.



Behavioural Questions

Demonstrating your mindset, work ethic, and approach to challenges as a future BI Analyst.

How to Handle Behavioral Questions If This Is Your First BI Job

Many entry-level candidates worry about answering behavioural questions when they don't have full-time BI experience yet.

The good news: Interviewers aren't only looking for BI work stories — **they're looking for transferable skills.**

What you can talk about:

- **University** group projects (e.g., working on a data project together)
- **Online course** projects (if you collaborated with classmates or did capstone projects)
- **Freelance** or volunteer work (even if unpaid, it's still real experience)
- **Past non-BI jobs** (any teamwork, problem-solving, communication counts)
- **Personal projects** (especially if you worked with others)

How to structure your answers:

- Briefly explain the situation (even if it's outside of BI)
- Highlight the teamwork, communication, or problem-solving skills you used
- Show a positive result (even a small one!)

How to Handle Behavioral Questions If This Is Your First BI Job (cont.)

It's better to give an honest, real-world example from another context than to try to "fake" experience you don't have.

Example for a new BI Analyst:

Question:

"Tell me about a time you worked with a team to solve a problem."

Answer:

"During my university final project, I worked with three classmates to build a dashboard. We faced missing data halfway through. I helped organize a quick meeting, and we realigned tasks so we could deliver on time. It taught me the importance of clear communication and flexibility when working as a team."

Final tip:

Focus on the skills - teamwork, communication, adaptability - not just the setting.

That's what interviewers really care about.

Behavioural

Question 1

Tell me about a time you had to work under a tight deadline.

Tip

Focus on time management, prioritization, and staying calm under pressure.

Structure

Brief situation and the tight deadline; How you planned and organized tasks; How you communicated progress; Outcome

Example Answer

While creating a sales dashboard for an internal review, I had only two days. I broke the work into small tasks, prioritized key metrics first, and updated the manager daily. We delivered the essential parts on time, and I added enhancements afterward.

Behavioural

Question 2

Describe a situation where you had to explain technical information to a non-technical stakeholder.

Tip

Show how you simplify complex ideas without being condescending.

Structure

Situation and audience; How you adjusted your language; Tools or visuals you used; Result

Example Answer

While presenting a data quality report, I used simple charts and avoided jargon. I compared missing data to missing puzzle pieces, which helped managers understand the impact without needing technical detail.

Behavioural

Question 3

Tell me about a time you faced a difficult stakeholder. How did you handle it?

Tip

Focus on empathy, communication, and professionalism.

Structure

Brief conflict situation; How you listened and stayed professional; How you found a compromise or solution

Example Answer

A stakeholder disagreed with my data selections. I listened to their concerns, validated their perspective, and explained my choices clearly. We agreed to adjust the report to meet both needs.

Behavioural

Question 4

Give an example of a mistake you made in a project and how you handled it.

Tip

Interviewers want to see accountability, problem-solving, and learning.

Structure

The mistake (brief and honest); How you identified it; How you fixed it; What you learned

Example Answer

Early in a reporting project, I pulled outdated product IDs. I noticed inconsistencies during review, quickly corrected the data, and updated stakeholders. Since then, I double-check data sources at the start of every project.

Behavioural

Question 5

Describe a time you worked with a team to solve a problem.

Tip

Focus on collaboration, communication, and shared ownership.

Structure

Problem situation; Team dynamics and your role;
How you contributed to the solution; Result

Example Answer

When building a KPI dashboard, I worked with marketing and finance teams. I facilitated meetings to align definitions and coordinated updates. The final dashboard improved cross-team reporting by 30%.

Behavioural

Question 6

Tell me about a time you managed multiple tasks or projects at once.

Tip

Interviewers want to see organization and prioritization skills.

Structure

Situation with competing priorities; How you organized and tracked tasks; How you managed deadlines; Outcome

Example Answer

I juggled building two dashboards and cleaning a data source at once. I created a task board, set mini-deadlines, and allocated focus time for each task. Both projects were completed on schedule.

Behavioural

Question 7

Give an example of how you handled receiving critical feedback.

Tip

Show openness, maturity, and willingness to improve.

Structure

Situation where you got critical feedback; How you reacted; What actions you took to improve

Example Answer

A manager pointed out that my initial dashboard was too complex. I thanked them for the feedback, simplified the visuals based on their suggestions, and received positive responses after the revision.

Behavioural

Question 8

Tell me about a time you identified a problem others didn't notice.

Tip

Demonstrate attention to detail and proactiveness.

Structure

Briefly describe the unnoticed issue; How you spotted it; How you acted on it; Impact

Example Answer

While reviewing a sales dataset, I noticed duplicate customer records affecting totals. I flagged it to the team, cleaned the data, and improved the report's accuracy by 15%.

Behavioural

Question 9

Describe a time you learned a new tool or technology quickly.

Tip

Highlight adaptability, learning, and resourcefulness.

Structure

Tool or technology; How you learned it (resources, self-study, practice); How you applied it

Example Answer

When tasked with building a dashboard in Tableau (which I hadn't used before), I followed online tutorials and built a prototype within three days. The manager approved it with only minor changes.

Behavioural

Question 10

Tell me about a time you worked on a project that changed scope midway.

Tip

Focus on flexibility, communication, and keeping projects on track.

Structure

Original scope; What changed and why; How you adapted; Outcome

Example Answer

Midway through building a marketing dashboard, leadership shifted focus from campaign to product performance. I quickly met with stakeholders to update requirements, adjusted the dashboard layout, and still met the original deadline.

Behavioural

Question 11

Describe a time when you had to prioritize your work with limited guidance.

Tip

Highlight prioritization, decision-making, and independence.

Structure

Workload situation; How you assessed priorities; How you communicated decisions; Result

Example Answer

While working on several reports, I created a priority list based on deadlines and business impact. I communicated my plan to my manager and completed all tasks on time.

Behavioural

Question 12

Tell me about a time you successfully managed a conflict within a team.

Tip

Focus on communication, empathy, and collaborative problem-solving.

Structure

Conflict situation; How you listened to each side;
How you mediated or contributed to resolution;
Result

Example Answer

During a project, two team members disagreed on the best KPI to use. I facilitated a short meeting where each explained their reasoning. We combined ideas to create a better solution that both supported.

Behavioural

Question 13

Give an example of a time you proactively improved a process.

Tip

Demonstrate initiative, problem-solving, and impact.

Structure

Situation or process; What you noticed; How you improved it; Outcome

Example Answer

I noticed that monthly reporting was done manually and took several hours. I created a simple SQL query and an automated Excel template, reducing the reporting time by 50%.

Behavioural

Question 14

Tell me about a time you handled an unexpected problem during a project.

Tip

Focus on adaptability and creative problem-solving.

Structure

Describe the unexpected problem; How you responded; Outcome

Example Answer

While preparing a final dashboard, the source table suddenly changed structure. I quickly adapted the SQL queries, verified new fields, and delivered the dashboard without delay.

Behavioural

Question 15

Describe a time when you had to gather requirements from different stakeholders.

Tip

Highlight stakeholder management and communication skills.

Structure

Stakeholder needs; How you gathered information; How you handled conflicts or inconsistencies

Example Answer

When gathering requirements for a new report, I met with marketing, finance, and sales teams separately. I mapped out their needs and clarified overlaps to design a report that worked for all departments.

Behavioural

Question 16

Tell me about a situation where you received vague or incomplete instructions. What did you do?

Tip

Show problem-solving skills and seeking clarification.

Structure

Describe vague instructions; How you sought clarification; How you kept moving forward

Example Answer

When given vague instructions for a dashboard, I sent a clarification email listing specific questions and proposed a draft version. This helped confirm expectations and avoid wasted effort.

Behavioural

Question 17

Describe a time you worked with a team member you disagreed with.

Tip

Focus on professionalism and finding common ground.

Structure

Describe disagreement; How you handled it professionally; Result

Example Answer

While collaborating on a project, a teammate and I disagreed on visualization choices. I suggested we test both with users and let feedback guide the decision, which led to a better final product.

Behavioural

Question 18

Tell me about a project where you had to balance quality and speed.

Tip

Demonstrate decision-making under pressure.

Structure

Describe project expectations; How you balanced quality and deadlines; Result

Example Answer

Facing a tight deadline, I focused first on data accuracy, then simplified visual designs to meet delivery dates without sacrificing core quality. Stakeholders appreciated the balance.

Behavioural

Question 19

Describe a time when you took ownership of a project without being asked.

Tip

Show initiative, leadership, and accountability.

Structure

Situation; Why you stepped up; What you did;
Outcome

Example Answer

When a key analyst left during a project, I stepped up without being asked. I took ownership of their tasks, coordinated with stakeholders, and helped the team meet the project deadline.

Behavioural

Question 20

Tell me about a time you worked with a large, messy dataset.

Tip

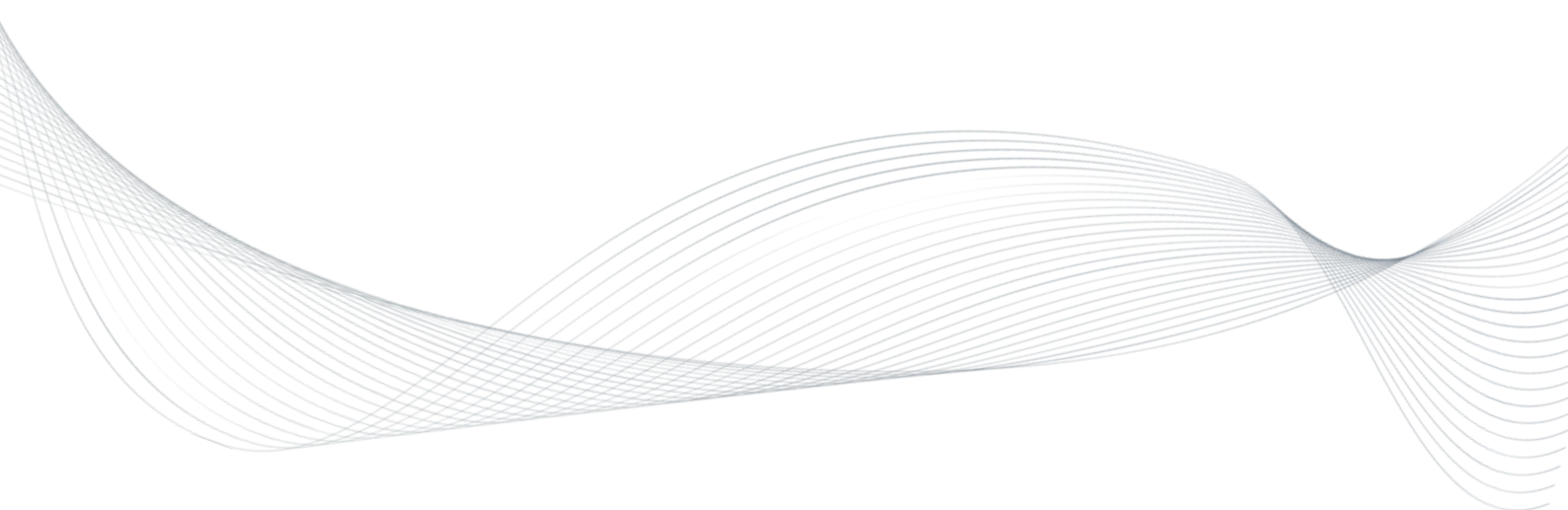
Focus on data cleaning, attention to detail, and persistence.

Structure

Initial data issues; How you cleaned and prepared the dataset; Impact on analysis

Example Answer

I received a customer dataset with inconsistent entries. I cleaned duplicates, standardized fields, and documented the issues for future reference, resulting in more reliable reporting.



Business/Scenario -Based Questions

Applying analytical thinking to real-world business challenges and stakeholder needs.

Business/Scenario-Based

In addition to **technical** skills and **behavioral** strengths, successful Business Intelligence Analysts need strong **business** thinking.

This section focuses on **real-world scenarios** you might encounter when working with data, stakeholders, and business teams.

You'll be asked to **think critically, navigate ambiguity, and apply your analytical mindset** to support business goals.

Use these questions and example answers to practice structuring your thoughts clearly and demonstrating practical problem-solving skills.

Understanding business context is just as important as knowing your tools — and it's a skill that will set you apart as a BI professional.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 1

A sales manager says the dashboard you built is showing lower revenue numbers than expected. How would you handle this?

Tip

Focus on calmly validating the data, investigating potential reasons, and communicating findings clearly.

Example Answer

I would first verify the data source and refresh to confirm accuracy. Then I'd review any filters or aggregation rules that might affect totals. If needed, I would walk through the dashboard logic with the manager to explain findings and correct any misunderstandings.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 2

How would you approach building a dashboard for a marketing team that isn't sure exactly what they want to track?

Tip

Focus on asking open questions to uncover needs, proposing draft visuals, and refining based on feedback.

Example Answer

I would start by asking questions about their campaign goals and success metrics. I'd propose a basic draft dashboard with key metrics like conversions, spend, and impressions to get initial feedback, then refine it through collaboration.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 3

A stakeholder wants you to include 30 KPIs in a single dashboard page. What would you do?

Tip

Focus on prioritization and guiding stakeholders toward clearer communication.

Example Answer

I would suggest starting with the most critical KPIs tied to their goals. I'd explain that too many metrics can overwhelm users and that we could create additional drill-down pages if needed to keep the main dashboard clean and actionable.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 4

You are asked to integrate a new data source into an existing report. What steps would you take?

Tip

Highlight careful planning, testing, and communication with the team.

Example Answer

I would first assess the new data source's structure and quality. Then I'd plan how to connect it to existing datasets, update data models if needed, and thoroughly test the new fields before publishing updates to the report.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 5

How would you explain a complex SQL query you wrote to a non-technical manager?

Tip

Focus on simplifying without dumbing down — explain logic, not syntax.

Example Answer

I would describe the query's goal first (e.g., 'this pulls customers who made a purchase in the last 30 days'), then break down the key steps in plain language, avoiding technical terms unless necessary.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 6

A report you've built shows different figures than a stakeholder's spreadsheet. How do you approach the discrepancy?

Tip

Stay calm, compare definitions and logic, and suggest walking through both reports together.

Example Answer

I would suggest setting up a meeting to walk through both sets of numbers, compare calculations, and document any differences to resolve the issue together.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 7

How would you prioritize requests when multiple stakeholders ask for different urgent reports?

Tip

Prioritize based on business impact and deadlines, communicate transparently with all stakeholders.

Example Answer

I would rank the tasks based on deadlines and business impact, communicate my plan to all stakeholders, and ask for alignment on priorities if needed.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 8

Describe how you would gather requirements for a new dashboard project.

Tip

Start with open-ended questions to understand needs, then document and confirm requirements.

Example Answer

I would start with a discovery meeting to ask about their goals, KPIs, and challenges, then summarize back my understanding before starting design.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 9

You notice the data quality in a new source is poor. What do you do?

Tip

Raise concerns about data quality early, document issues, and suggest cleaning or alternative sources.

Example Answer

I would document data issues clearly, alert stakeholders, and propose either fixing the data at the source or applying cleansing rules in reports.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 10

A dashboard's performance is very slow after adding new data. How would you improve it?

Tip

Optimize queries, remove unnecessary visuals, and consider aggregating data where possible.

Example Answer

I would optimize SQL queries, limit the number of visuals loading at once, aggregate large datasets where possible, and improve report load times.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 11

How would you approach designing a dashboard for executives versus one for operational staff?

Tip

Executives need summaries and insights; operational staff need more granular, actionable detail.

Example Answer

For executives, I would prioritize KPIs and trends at a high level; for operational users, I would include more filters and detailed breakdowns.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 12

A stakeholder insists on adding a metric you believe is misleading. How would you handle it?

Tip

Acknowledge their expertise but explain how misleading metrics can create confusion or bad decisions.

Example Answer

I would respectfully explain that misleading metrics could drive incorrect decisions, and suggest reviewing the metric's purpose together before finalizing.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 13

How would you handle a situation where you realize an error in a report you already shared?

Tip

Own the mistake quickly, communicate the correction, and update the report as soon as possible.

Example Answer

I would immediately notify users about the issue, correct it in the report, and clearly communicate the change to maintain trust.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 14

You're asked to build a forecast based only on three months of data. What do you do?

Tip

Explain limitations of forecasting with short history and suggest cautious interpretation.

Example Answer

I would explain that forecasts from limited data have higher uncertainty and suggest using confidence intervals or caution in interpretation.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 15

How would you explain the importance of data normalization to a business user?

Tip

Use simple examples to explain how normalization ensures clean, comparable data.

Example Answer

I would explain that normalization avoids duplicate entries, misalignments, and ensures easier reporting across different systems.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 16

A client wants real-time dashboards, but the data source updates only daily. How would you explain this?

Tip

Set realistic expectations about update frequency and suggest alternative KPIs if needed.

Example Answer

I would explain that while real-time data isn't available, we can still create daily reports that meet their needs and avoid confusion.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 17

You're asked to automate a manual reporting process. How would you approach it?

Tip

Understand the manual steps, map them, and use automation tools like scheduled queries or scripting.

Example Answer

I would document the current manual steps, look for patterns, and propose automating repetitive tasks using SQL scheduling or scripts.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 18

Describe how you would document a dashboard project for future users.

Tip

Document the purpose, filters, data sources, key calculations, and any limitations of the dashboard.

Example Answer

I would create a documentation page listing the dashboard's source data, filters, refresh schedules, and definitions of each key metric.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 19

How would you handle conflicting definitions of a KPI across departments?

Tip

Work toward a common definition or offer separate views to accommodate different needs.

Example Answer

I would organize a workshop to agree on a common definition or, if necessary, show separate versions for clarity across departments.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 20

You're working on a dashboard, but new business needs emerge halfway through. What's your approach?

Tip

Revalidate the project scope with stakeholders and adjust timelines and priorities transparently.

Example Answer

I would set up a short meeting to realign project goals and adjust timelines, communicating the impact of new requirements clearly.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 21

A stakeholder doesn't engage during requirements gathering sessions. How would you proceed?

Tip

Follow up individually to understand needs and offer draft examples to encourage feedback.

Example Answer

I would follow up individually by email or quick chats to gather requirements in a less formal, lower-pressure way.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 22

How would you validate the accuracy of your report before sharing it with leadership?

Tip

Double-check queries, filters, and calculations; perform manual spot checks if necessary.

Example Answer

I would manually cross-check samples of the output against source systems, confirm aggregation rules, and validate before delivery.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 23

You're asked to pull historical data from a system you don't have direct access to. What steps would you take?

Tip

Request read-only access, collaborate with system admins, or use available export files.

Example Answer

I would request access through admins, or if not possible, ask for CSV exports or collaborate with someone who has access.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 24

Describe how you would set up data access permissions for a sensitive dashboard.

Tip

Define user groups and permissions early; limit access based on need-to-know.

Example Answer

I would create groups in the BI tool (e.g., finance, sales) and restrict access to only the dashboards or data they need.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 25

You're assigned to a project with very limited documentation. How would you get up to speed?

Tip

Interview subject matter experts, check any available historical files, and test assumptions.

Example Answer

I would speak with internal users, review whatever historical reports or notes exist, and document assumptions as I go.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 26

A stakeholder wants to see highly detailed raw data in a dashboard. How would you balance detail vs summary?

Tip

Recommend summarizing key figures first with optional drilldowns for raw data as needed.

Example Answer

I would propose summarizing key metrics visually, while offering detailed tables as drilldowns or optional downloads.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 27

You're asked to recommend KPIs for a new business initiative. How would you approach it?

Tip

Ask about business goals first, then suggest KPIs that align directly with those outcomes.

Example Answer

I would ask what decisions the initiative aims to drive, then select KPIs that tie directly to measuring those outcomes.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 28

Describe how you would handle a situation where two reports are showing different results for the same metric.

Tip

Review filters, calculations, and definitions; work with owners to standardize one version of the truth.

Example Answer

I would schedule a working session to align filters and calculations between the reports, then update both to a consistent definition.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 29

You need to explain why certain fields are missing from a report after a database migration. What's your approach?

Tip

Explain migration challenges simply and suggest a plan for restoring or recreating missing fields.

Example Answer

I would explain that migrations sometimes cause schema changes, and I would outline a clear plan to recover or rebuild missing fields.

Business/Scenario-Based

Question 30

How would you design a dashboard when different user groups (sales, finance, marketing) all have slightly different needs?

Tip

Create modular views if needed or prioritize shared metrics across groups first.

Example Answer

I would design a main dashboard view showing shared KPIs, then offer department-specific tabs or filters if needed.

Thank you

Congratulations on completing the 100 BI Analyst Interview Questions guide.

Preparing for interviews is an important step — but truly standing out as a candidate requires real-world project experience and practical BI skills.

If you're serious about launching your career as a Business Intelligence Analyst, take the next step with the BI Analyst Starter Program.



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